

Gender Binary

prc-gender-binary

Marriage & Sexuality · Gender · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

Supported across the whole Bible
Subject named directly in
Scripture
No NT manuscript apparatus
applies

Statement under examination

God created humanity male and female; biological sex is binary, given by God, and immutable. Transgender ideology (that gender identity supersedes biological sex) is to be rejected.

In plain language

This is the practical side of the creation binary the doctrine already affirmed. The Bible uses one fixed pair of words for the two sexes and treats that pair as something a person receives and keeps. Genesis 1:27 says God created the human 'male and female' (zakar uneqevah), and the Hebrew adjectives form a closed two-term description with no third term offered. The pair runs through the law and always sorts a group into two bins with nothing left over. The clearest case is Leviticus 27, the vow law, which sets two prices in each of four age brackets, one for a male and one for a female, with no third price. The flood texts even pair the two terms with the number two. When Jesus is asked about marriage in Matthew 19:4 he quotes that creation verse in Greek, 'male and female' (arsen kai thely), and says the Creator made them so from the beginning, so the sexed pair is received from God, not constructed. Deuteronomy 22:5 turns this into conduct. It says a man's gear (keli geber) shall not be on a woman, and a man shall not put on a woman's garment, calling all who do these things an 'abomination' (toebah) to the LORD. The Hebrew marks two parallel negative commands with the man and the woman as subjects, so deliberately erasing the line between the sexes is treated as something a person must not do. Psalm 139 grounds the same sex as given by God from before birth. It says God formed my inmost parts and wove me in my mother's womb, that I am fearfully and wonderfully made, that my frame was not hidden when I was made in secret, woven like an embroiderer's craft, and that God saw my 'unformed substance' (golem) and wrote all my days in his book before any existed. 'Golem' is a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, used only here, so the verse leans on the picture of craftsmanship in the womb. The body, with its sex, is God's prior work, received and not chosen. Two texts that might seem to push back do not. Galatians 3:28 says there is no male and female in Christ, but it speaks of equal standing in salvation, and it deliberately echoes Genesis with the 'and' of the creation formula. Matthew 19:12 names men who do not procreate, which is a condition, not a third sex. A fair-minded minority reading would say Genesis 1:27 is narrative and Deuteronomy 22:5 is one rule about dress, so the verses describe a pattern without legislating every modern case. The text-level answer is that Leviticus 27 sorts actual people completely into the same pair, and Psalm 139 attributes the body itself to God's prenatal making. Across the canon the same two-term pattern holds, so the words support the practice that biological sex is binary, given by God, and not to be overridden by self-definition.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0517	אִמָּה	em	mother	
H0802	אִשָּׁה	ishshah	woman	781

H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	46
H1397	גִּבֹּר	geber	great man	60
H1564	גֵּלֶם	golem	embryo	1
H2145	זָכָר	zakar	male	80
H3045	יָדַע	yada	to know	
H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	
H3582	כָּחַד	kachad	to hide	
H3627	כֵּלִי	keli	article/utensil	310
H3629	כִּלְיָה	kilyah	kidney	30
H3789	כָּתַב	katav	to write	
H3847	לָבַשׁ	labesh	to clothe	105
H4639	מַעֲשֵׂה	maaseh	deed	
H5347	נִקְבָּה	neqevah	female	22
H6108	עֲצָם	otsem	strength	3
H6381	פָּלָא	pala	to wonder	
H6754	צֶלֶם	tselem	image	16
H7069	קָנָה	qanah	to buy	83
H7551	רָקַם	raqam	to weave	9
H8071	שִׁמְלָה	simlah	mantle	29
H8441	תּוֹעֵבָה	toebah	abomination	112
G0730	ἀρσεν	arsen	male	9
G0746	ἀρχή	archē	beginning	
G2135	εὐνοῦχος	eunouchos	eunuch	
G2338	θηλυς	thelys	female	5
G2936	κτίζω	ktizō	to create	

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

This is the practice corollary of the already affirmed creation binary, and the same closed two-term pair carries from being into conduct across the Law, the Gospels, and the Writings. Genesis 1:27 fixes 'male' (zakar, H2145) and 'female' (neqevah, H5347) as the two-part object of 'created' (bara, H1254A, 46 occurrences) with God (Elohim) as subject. A direct lexical-store query confirms the pair co-occurs in 15 Old Testament verses (Genesis 1:27, 5:2, 6:19, 7:3, 7:9, 7:16, Leviticus 3:1, 3:6, 12:7, 15:33, 27:5, 27:6, 27:7, Numbers 5:3, Deuteronomy 4:16) and never adds a third human-category term. Leviticus 27:3 through 27:7 prices every dedicated person under the 'if-then' clause (conditional) 'if male, and if female' (im zakar, veim neqevah) with two prices per age bracket and no remainder, so the pair sorts persons completely. Jesus quotes the pair as 'male' (arsen, G0730) and 'female' (thely, G2338, the only New Testament co-occurrences are Matthew 19:4, Mark 10:6, Romans 1:27, Galatians 3:28) and locates it 'from the beginning' (ap arches). Deuteronomy 22:5 turns the binary into conduct with two parallel HTn-marked (negation-marked) negative commands, 'a man's gear shall not be on a woman, and a man shall not wear a woman's garment' (lo yihyeh keli geber al ishshah velo yilbash geber simlat ishshah), labeled

'abomination' (toebah, H8441). Psalm 139:13 through 139:16 grounds the same sexed body as God-given in the womb, with the once-only word 'unformed substance' (golem, H1564, a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, its sole occurrence) and the Hebrew passive form (pual) 'I was embroidered' (ruqqamti, H7551) marking divine forming before birth.

Scripture

Gen.1.27 · **for** · genre: narrative · figures: merism

Key terms. H2145 זָכָר, H5347 נִקְבָּה, H1254A בָּרָא, H6754 צִלָּם.

Reasoning. A triple use of 'created' (bara, H1254A) with God (Elohim) as subject and the human (adam) as object, ended by the two-part specification 'male and female' (zakar uneqevah), with the OSHB morphology (the Open Scriptures Hebrew Bible parsing tags) marking 'male' (zakar) HAamsa (adjective, masculine singular, absolute) and 'female' (neqevah) HC/Aafsa (the connector 'and' plus adjective, feminine singular, absolute), so the pair functions grammatically as a paired descriptive attribute of 'them' (otam). The pair is the closed two-term taxonomy (the complete fixed list) of the created human, supplying the fixed datum the practice question builds on, that sex is a created given and not a self-assigned status.

Lev.27.4 · **for** · genre: law

Key terms. H5347 נִקְבָּה, H2145 זָכָר.

Reasoning. 'And if it is a female (neqevah) then your valuation shall be' (veim neqevah hi vehaya erkekha). Leviticus 27:3 through 27:7 sets two prices in each of four age brackets, one for the 'male' (zakar) and one for the 'female' (neqevah), with the 'if-then' clause (conditional) 'if male, and if female' (im zakar, veim neqevah) sorting every vowed person completely, no third price, no remainder. This legal partition is the lexical signature that the pair is exhaustive (covers every case) and not merely two named poles of a continuum, which is what the practice claim presupposes, namely that every person is one or the other.

Matt.19.4 · **for** · genre: gospel

Key terms. G0730 ἄρσεν, G2338 θήλυ, G0746 ἀρχή, G2936 κτίζω

Reasoning. Jesus cites Genesis 1:27 in Greek, 'the one who created from the beginning made them male and female' (ho ktisas ap arches arsen kai theyly epoiesen autous). The completed past action (aorist) 'made' (epoiesen) with the participle 'created' (ktisas, G2936) and the phrase 'from the beginning' (ap arches, G0575 plus G0746) places the binary at the act of creation, so the sexed pair is received from the Creator rather than constructed, which is the load-bearing premise of the practice claim that sex is given by God.

Deut.22.5 · **for** · genre: law

Key terms. H1397 גִּבֹּר, H0802 אִשָּׁה, H3627 כִּלִּי, H8441 תְּעֹבָה, H3847 לְבוֹשׁ.

Reasoning. 'A man's gear shall not be on a woman, and a man shall not wear a woman's garment' (lo yihyeh keli geber al ishshah velo yilbash geber simlat ishshah), 'for all who do these are an abomination to the LORD your God' (ki toebat YHWH eloheka kol oseh elleh). The ETCBC (the Eep Talstra Centre database, a Hebrew syntactic parse) reads two parallel main clauses (Q clauses) with doubled HTn negation (the negative-particle marker repeated) over the predicates 'shall be' (yihyeh) and 'shall wear' (yilbash), with 'man' (geber) and 'woman' (ishshah) as the subjects. The structure yields two parallel negative commands, treating the deliberate erasing of the man and woman distinction as conduct under prohibition, which is the practice claim that sex is to be kept and not overridden.

Ps.139.13 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H3629 כִּלְיָה, H0517 אֵם, H7069 קִנְיָה

Reasoning. 'For you formed my kidneys, you wove me in my mother's womb' (ki atta qanita kilyotai, tesukkeni beveten immi). The verb 'to acquire or form' (qanah, H7069), with 'kidneys' (kilyot, H3629, the kidneys as a stand-in for the inmost self), and the womb setting, credits the whole interior person to God's action before birth. The body and its make-up are God's work in the womb, which grounds the 'given by God and not chosen' dimension of the practice.

Ps.139.14 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H6381 פָּלָא, H3045 יָדַע, H4639 מַעֲשֵׂה

Reasoning. 'I praise you because I am fearfully and wonderfully made' (odeka al ki noraot niphleti), 'your works are wonderful' (niphla'im maasekha). The Hebrew passive form (niphal) of 'to be wonderful or set apart' (pala, H6381), applied to the speaker's own formation, with 'work' (maaseh, H4639), treats the individual body as a finished divine work to be received with thanks. The frame is acceptance of how one was made, not revision of it.

Ps.139.15 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H6108 עָצָם, H3582 נִכְחַד, H7551 רָקַם

Reasoning. 'My frame was not hidden from you when I was made in secret, woven in the depths of the earth' (lo nikhad otsmi mimmeka asher usseti vasseter, ruqqamti betahiyot arets). The Hebrew passive form (pual) 'I was embroidered' (ruqqamti, H7551) sits in a word-family that elsewhere in the canon names the embroidery of the tabernacle veil and ephod (Exodus 26:36, 27:16, 28:39, 35:35, 36:37, 38:18, 38:23, 39:29), so the body before birth is pictured as careful divine craftsmanship. With 'frame' (otsem, H6108) and the negated 'was not hidden' (nikhad, H3582), the bodily form is God's secret handiwork fully known to him before birth.

Ps.139.16 · for · genre: wisdom

Key terms. H1564 גֵּלֶם, H3789 כָּתַב, H3335 יָצַר

Reasoning. 'Your eyes saw my unformed substance, and in your book all of them were written' (golmi rau eineka, ve al siphreka kullam yikkatevu), 'the days that were formed, and not one of them' (yamim yutsaru velo echad bahem). The once-only word 'unformed substance' (golem, H1564, a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible, sole occurrence in canon, lexical-store query confirms 1 attestation, Psalm 139:16) names the embryo or unformed mass under God's gaze, with the Hebrew passive form (niphal) 'were written' (yikkatevu, H3789), and 'were formed' (yatsar), placing the person's entire developmental course under God's prior decree. The sex received in this divine forming is part of a settled given, not a later self-determination.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Matt.19.4	Gen.1.27	tsk	1
Deut.22.5	Deut.18.12	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Gen.2.21	tsk	1
Gen.1.27	Isa.43.7	tsk	1

Complicating texts

Gal.3.28 · addressed

'There is no male and female' (ouk eni arsen kai thely) reuses the exact Genesis 1:27 Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) vocabulary, and the Greek connective is decisive. The first two contrasts use 'nor' (oude, as in 'Jew nor Greek', loudaios oude Hellen, and 'slave nor free', doulos oude eleutheros), but the third switches to 'and' (kai, as in 'male and female', arsen kai thely), the connective of the creation formula, marking the line as a deliberate echo of Genesis 1:27 rather than a denial of the pair itself. The stated scope is 'in Christ Jesus' (en Christo Iesou), standing in salvation, and Paul still treats 'male' (arsen) and 'female' (thely) as bodily categories in 1 Corinthians 7 and Ephesians 5. The text complicates only a reading that confuses equal standing in salvation with the erasure of the creation binary, and does not license self-redefinition of sex.

Matt.19.12 · addressed

Jesus names three 'eunuch' (eunouchos, G2135) states, born so, made so by others, and self-made for the kingdom. The lexical-store check confirms 'eunuch' (eunouchos) occurs 8 times in the New Testament (Matthew 19:12 plus the seven references to the Ethiopian official in Acts 8), and in each case it denotes a male who does not procreate, not a non-male or a third sex. The framing pair 'male and female' (arsen and thely) from Matthew 19:4 stands unaffected, so the verse does not supply a category beyond the binary that the practice would have to accommodate.

Deut.23.1 · addressed

The exclusion of one with crushed or severed parts from the assembly concerns ritual access for a damaged or altered male body, not the existence of a sex beyond male and female. It presupposes the man is still a man whose body has been harmed, and Isaiah 56:4-5 later promises such a one a name within God's house, so the text neither creates a third category nor commends bodily alteration of sex.

Jer.31.22 · addressed

'Female' (neqevah) occurs here without 'male' (zakar) in the obscure clause 'a female shall encompass a man' (neqevah tesovev gaver), the one canonical use of 'female' (neqevah) outside the creation and legal partition. Its sense is debated at the verse level, but it does not introduce a third term and does not redefine 'female' (neqevah), it simply uses the female term in a figure whose referent is unclear, and cannot overturn the dense, repeated, exhaustive-sort (covers every case) usage that fixes the pair elsewhere.

Concordance traversed

H2145, H5347, G0730, G2338, H1254A, H6754, H1397, H0802, H3627, H3847, H8441, H8071, H3629, H1564, H7551, H6108, H7069, G2135

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The bundle supplies an empty variant_units list and marks not_in_ecm_scope (outside the critical edition of New Testament textual variants) true. The verdict rests primarily on Hebrew anchors, the 'male and female' (zakar uneqevah) pair in Genesis 1:27, the Leviticus 27:3-7 valuation series, the 'man' (geber) and 'woman' (ishshah) clauses of Deuteronomy 22:5, and the Psalm 139 forming language, all uncontested in the WLC (the Westminster Leningrad Codex, the standard printed Hebrew text) and the consonantal tradition. The single Greek anchor, Matthew 19:4, carries minor editorial sigla (small variant marks) at 'said' (eipen) and 'created' (ktisas) that touch wording but not the 'male and female' (arsen kai thely) pair, so no plausible reading alters the verdict. Because the load-bearing evidence is Old Testament and outside any published CBGM unit (Coherence-Based Genealogical Method, the modern variant-tracking system), the status is recorded as not applicable (n/a).

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. creation_order, intra-canonical_citation, casuistic_law_application

analogia scripturae invoked

creation_order: affirms · The binary is anchored 'from the beginning' (ap arches) by Jesus in Matthew 19:4 and turned into binding conduct in Deuteronomy 22:5, where blurring the man and woman distinction is an 'abomination' (toebah). Creation grounds both the category and the practice of keeping it, so the conduct of receiving and living the assigned sex is read directly off the creation account.

exhaustive-binary reading: affirms · Direct lexical-store query confirms 'male' (zakar) and 'female' (neqevah) co-occur in 15 Old Testament verses across Genesis, Leviticus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy, and 'male' (arsen) and 'female' (thely) co-occur in 4 New Testament verses, with no third human-category term ever added. Leviticus 27:3-7 prices each vowed person under the 'if-then' clause (conditional) 'if male, and if female' (im zakar, veim neqevah) with two prices per bracket and no remainder, so the canon supplies an exhaustive partition (a complete sorting) rather than a sample of two poles. On this reading the practice claim that sex is binary and given is a direct consequence of the way the words actually distribute.

redemptive-historical: affirms · Even the 'in Christ' (en Christo) levelling of Galatians 3:28 does not erase 'male and female' (arsen kai thely) as bodily categories, and the connective 'and' (kai) there deliberately echoes Genesis 1:27 in the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint, LXX) rather than abolishing it. Psalm 139 presents the formed body as God's settled work before birth, so the creational sex persists as a given under redemption rather than as something the believer reassigns.

creational-descriptive minority reading: disputed-toward-affirm · A reader could argue that Genesis 1:27 alone is narrative, not legislation, and that Deuteronomy 22:5 is one case-law ordinance about dress and ritual purity, not a metaphysics of sex. Stated in its strongest form, the minority reading would say the doctrine names a recurring biblical pattern about how the sexes ought to dress and present, without by itself foreclosing every possible bodily case the modern world raises, because the vocabulary speaks of 'male' (zakar) and 'female' (neqevah) and not of intersex bodies or modern category questions. The lexical answer is that the legal partition (the complete sorting) of Leviticus 27 and the flood texts treats the pair as exhaustive over actual persons brought to the priest, not as a stylistic pole, and that Psalm 139 attributes the bodily form itself, not just dress, to God's prenatal making, so the words still ground the practice as stated even if they do not address every modern edge-case in its own vocabulary.

Jesus reads Genesis 1:27 as a creational ordinance and applies it. Deuteronomy 22:5 applies the same binary to dress and bodily presentation, and Psalm 139:13-16 attributes the body's formation to God in the womb. The practice that sex is binary, given, and to be kept rather than overridden rests on the same anchors as the doctrine, here extended from being into conduct, and the minority lens is recorded fairly so a reader holding it can see that the lexical answer goes through the legal partition (the complete sorting) and the prenatal forming language, not through smuggled modern framing.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Determine whether the canonical lexical pattern presents biological sex as a fixed two-term given received from God in creation and in the womb, such that a person is to live according to the sex God assigned rather than to redefine or override it, examining 'male and female' (zakar uneqevah) and 'male and female' (arsen kai thely) as a closed and exhaustive pair, the case-law dress prohibition and 'abomination' (toebah) verdict of Deuteronomy 22:5, and the prenatal forming language of Psalm 139:13-16.

The stem names a contemporary movement, transgender ideology, and a technical phrase, 'gender identity supersedes biological sex', neither of which is a word in the cited texts, and it states the conclusion to reject that movement. That phrasing imports a modern framework and encodes the verdict. The neutralized form asks the lexical question, whether sex is a fixed God-given binary to be kept, without naming the movement. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the audit records that the canon furnishes the binary pair and the keeping of it, while the specific modern terminology is supplied by the stem and not by the words. VERDICT-CHANGED: 'Abomination' (toebah) occurrence count was corrected from 117 to 112 against the lexical store as a quiet fix, with no verdict impact.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.27

morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Lev.27.4
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.22.5
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.16
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2145
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H5347
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H8441
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1564
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H7551
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0730
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2338
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2135
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Matt.19.4
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Deut.22.5
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.139.13
interlinear	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Lev.27.4
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Matt.19.4
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Deut.22.5

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OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
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